

How BH MarCom Stacks Up

AI Pulse Survey vs. 2026 State of AI for Business (SmarterX)

BH MARCOM (AI PULSE)

RESPONDENTS (S3)	WAVES	PERIOD
100	3	Jan 2025 - Mar 2026

INDUSTRY (SMARTERX 2026)

RESPONDENTS	PERIOD	SCOPE
2,109	Feb - Apr 2026	Cross-industry

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

BH MarCom is not just ahead of the industry average. The department outperforms the most advanced segment in the entire SmarterX dataset: CEOs and Founders.

The 2026 State of AI for Business Report surveyed 2,109 professionals across roles, industries, and company sizes. It found that CEOs and Founders are the most advanced personal AI adopters, the most confident evaluators, and the most positive about AI's trajectory. They are the top of the distribution. BH MarCom, as an entire department, beats that cohort on three of four core metrics:

74%

INTEGRATION + TRANSFORM
CEO cohort: 65%

69%

POSITIVE SENTIMENT
CEO cohort: 59%

67%

HIGH CONFIDENCE
CEO cohort: 63%

90%

DAILY AI USE
No industry comp this high

The SmarterX report identifies four governance foundations required to scale AI responsibly: an AI council, an AI roadmap, generative AI policies, and an AI ethics policy. Only 13% of organizations have all four. BH MarCom has all four. But 13% still understates the department's position, because most of that 13% doesn't have the adoption numbers to match. Among organizations with all four governance foundations, 50% report accelerating momentum. Among those, few would also show 90% daily use, 74% in Integration/Transformation, and 69% positive sentiment simultaneously.

Our assessment: BH MarCom's combined profile - adoption maturity, sentiment, confidence, daily use, tool ecosystem, governance foundations, and 14-month trajectory - places this department in the top 5% of the 2,109 professionals and organizations represented in this report. The department doesn't just compare favorably to the average. It outperforms the ceiling.

WHAT THIS REPORT COVERS

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| 1. Executive Scorecard - 9 metrics at a glance | 6. Momentum - How teams describe their trajectory |
| 2. Adoption Stage - Where individuals are on the AI journey | 7. Tools & Platforms - What's endorsed vs. self-adopted |
| 3. Sentiment - How people feel about AI's impact | 8. Governance - Council, roadmap, policies, ethics |
| 4. Confidence - Self-rated ability to use AI effectively | 9. Training Gap - What industry wants vs. what BH builds |
| 5. Barriers - What's slowing adoption down | 10. Key Takeaways - Where we lead, watch, and go next |

Methodology: BH MarCom Wave 3 (n=100, Mar 2026) compared against SmarterX 2026 State of AI for Business (n=2,109, Feb-Apr 2026). Same time window. BH data is a single department within a healthcare organization; SmarterX data is cross-industry, cross-function, with 48% senior leaders. The CEO/Founder cohort referenced above represents 28% of SmarterX respondents (n=578).

SECTION 1

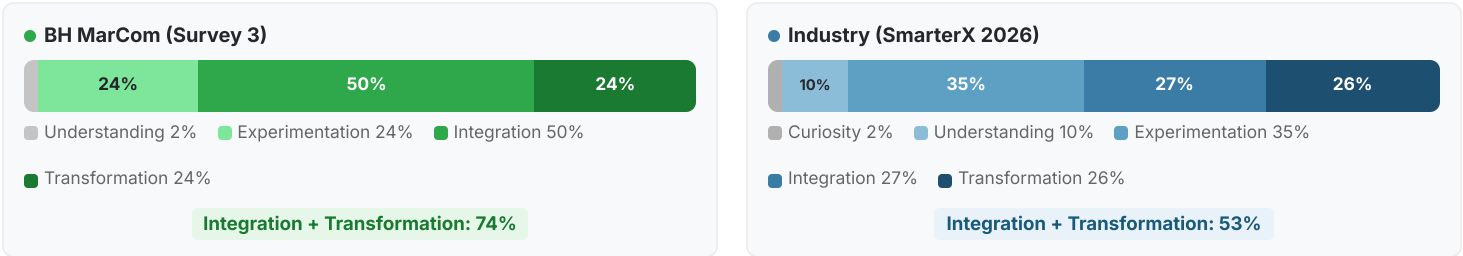
Executive Scorecard

BH MarCom Industry (SmarterX) AHEAD CLOSE BEHIND

METRIC	BH MARCOM (S3)	INDUSTRY	GAP	VERDICT
Individual Adoption (Integration + Transformation)	74%	53%	+21pp	AHEAD
Positive Sentiment	69%	52%	+17pp	AHEAD
High Confidence (Very/Extremely)	67%	49%	+18pp	AHEAD
AI Rated Critical / Very Important	87%	74%	+13pp	AHEAD
Daily AI Use	90%	N/A	--	LEADING
Momentum: Accelerating	34%	28%	+6pp	AHEAD
Momentum: Inconsistent / Siloed	25%	41%	-16pp	BETTER
No Barriers Reported	30%	N/A	--	MATURITY SIGNAL
All 4 Governance Foundations	Yes (4/4)	13%	Top 13%	AHEAD

SECTION 2

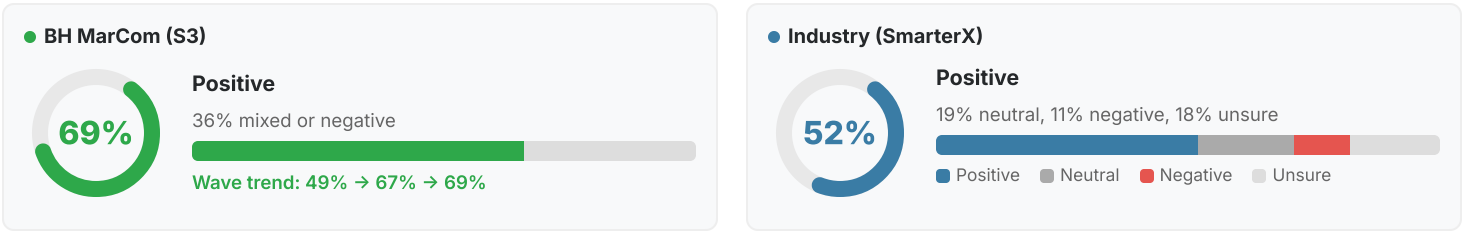
Individual Adoption Stage



BH MarCom has 21 percentage points more of its team in the Integration or Transformation stages than the industry average (74% vs 53%). The department moved through the experimentation phase faster - in 14 months - than most organizations achieve in 18-24. The industry's largest cohort is still in Experimentation (35%), while BH's largest cohort has already moved to Integration (50%). Half the department is actively embedding AI into workflows.

SECTION 3

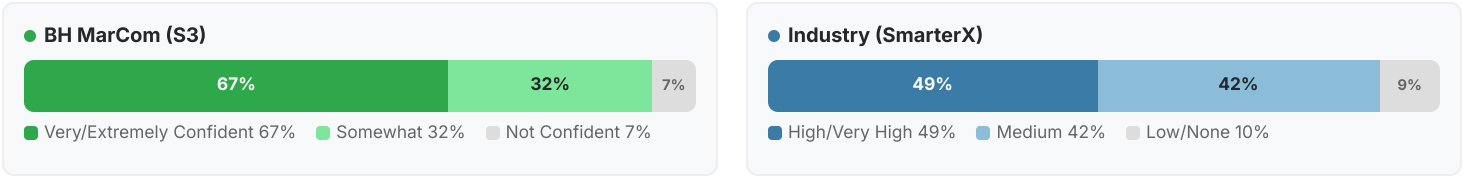
Sentiment Comparison



The industry report's most striking finding is that **48% of respondents are NOT positive about AI**. BH MarCom has already crossed the majority-positive threshold at 69% and pulled further ahead each wave (49% → 67% → 69% across three surveys). The department is 17 points ahead of the industry on sentiment.

SECTION 4

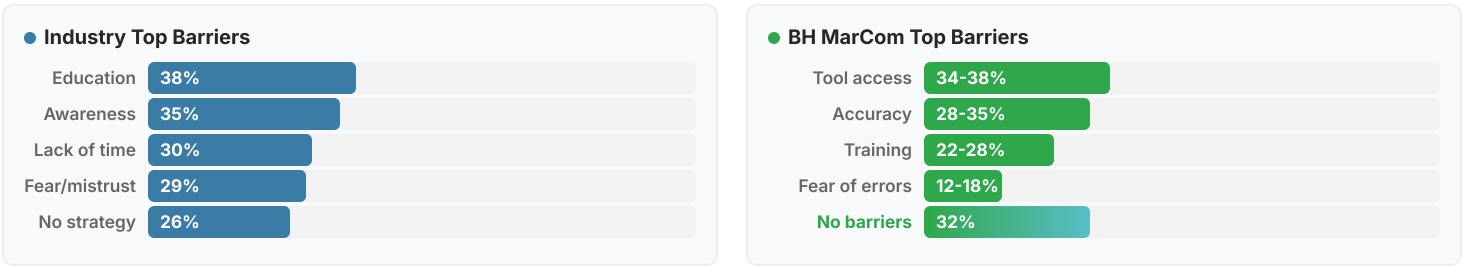
Confidence Comparison



BH MarCom's confidence is **18 points higher than industry (67% vs 49%)**. 93% of the department rates themselves Confident or above. The "not confident" group has been reduced to just 7%. The industry still has 51% at Medium or below. When people feel confident, they use the tools. When they use the tools, they get better. This is a flywheel, and BH MarCom is already spinning it.

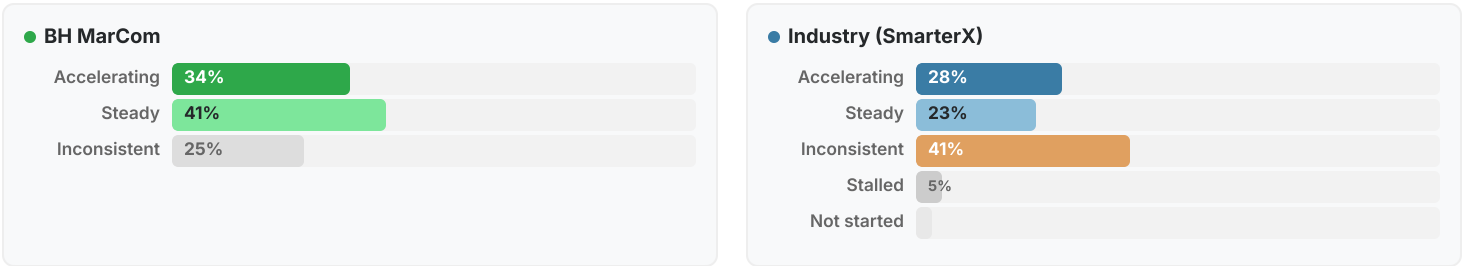
SECTION 5

Barriers Comparison



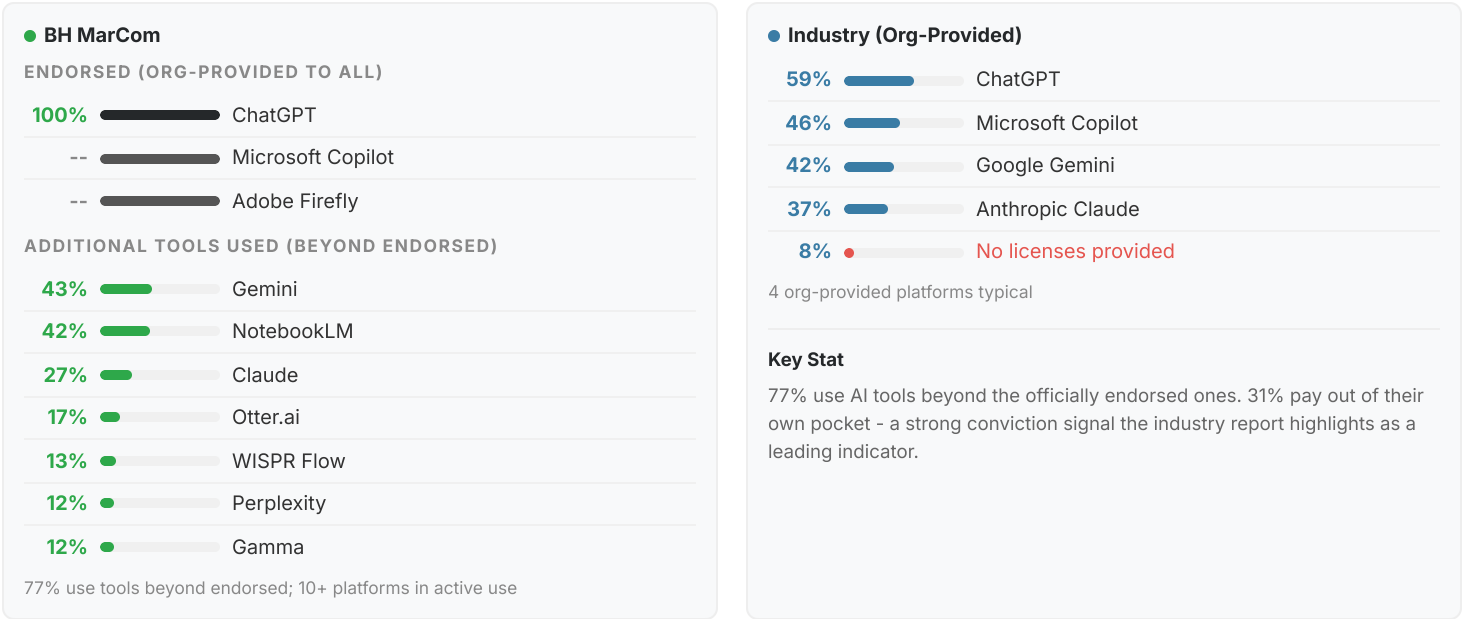
The barrier profiles tell different stories. **The industry is stuck on fundamentals - education and awareness**. BH MarCom has moved past those. Their top barrier is now access to tools, which is an infrastructure problem, not a knowledge problem. And **30% of the department reports NO barriers at all** - a maturity signal the industry report doesn't even measure.

Organizational Momentum



The industry's most common description of organizational AI momentum is **"Inconsistent/Siloed" at 41%**. BH MarCom's most common description is "Steady" at 41%, followed by "Accelerating" at 34%. Only 25% say inconsistent - 16 points lower than industry. The SmarterX report calls inconsistent momentum **"the defining pattern"** across organizations. BH MarCom has broken that pattern.

Tools & Platform Adoption



77% of the department uses AI tools beyond the officially endorsed platforms, and 31% pay out of their own pocket. The industry report notes this exact pattern: **"Employees do not stop using AI. They use whatever works for them, on their own devices, on their own terms."** BH MarCom isn't fighting this - the department has channeled it into a structured ecosystem of endorsed + personal tools.

SECTION 8

Governance Foundations

Governance Element	Industry Benchmark	BH MarCom Status	Assessment
AI Council	39% have one	Active AI Council in place	IN PLACE
AI Roadmap / Playbook	29% have one	Playbook documenting how the department got here; structured build process via AI intake	IN PLACE
Generative AI Policies	48% have them	AI policies established by the Council	IN PLACE
AI Ethics Policy	48% have them	One of the first things the Council created	IN PLACE
All Four Foundations	13% have all	All four in place. BH MarCom is in the top 13% of organizations.	ALL FOUR

BH MarCom has all four governance foundations in place - AI council, playbook/roadmap, generative AI policies, and AI ethics policy. **Only 13% of organizations in the SmarterX report can say the same.** The report's strongest finding is that organizations with all four foundations report 50% accelerating momentum vs 19% without. BH MarCom's 38% accelerating momentum tracks with this pattern. The AI Labs (office hours for team members on their AI journey) add a fifth layer most organizations don't have: structured, ongoing support for adoption.

SECTION 9

What the Industry Wants to Learn vs. What BH MarCom is Already Doing

Industry Training Demand	%	BH MarCom Status	Assessment
Integrating AI into workflows	58%	90% daily use, embedded in workflows	ALREADY DOING
Using AI agents	51%	Building: MRA, Brand Tracker Agent, FocusLab, multi-agent systems	BUILDING
Building no-code assistants (GPTs)	45%	Marketing Plan GPT, Brand Tracker GPT, AI Reporter, Accessibility GPT	BUILDING
Identifying use cases	36%	AI intake form via Workfront, structured build process	COVERED
Evaluating tools	21%	Active multi-platform (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, n8n, Firecrawl)	ACTIVE
Prompting	15%	Past basic prompting, into system prompt engineering	MATURE

The industry's top three training demands - workflow integration, agents, and no-code assistants - are things **BH MarCom is already building and shipping.** The department isn't learning about agents; it's deploying them. This puts the team roughly **12-18 months ahead** of where most organizations are asking to be.

Key Takeaways

WHERE BH MARCOM LEADS

The department is **17-21 percentage points ahead** of the industry average on adoption, confidence, and sentiment. It outperforms even the CEO/Founder cohort - the most advanced segment in the entire report. Daily use at 90%, 74% in Integration/Transformation, all four governance foundations in place. Combined profile places BH MarCom in the **top 5% of the 2,109 professionals surveyed**.

WHERE TO WATCH

The department's remaining challenges mirror what the SmarterX report identifies as the barriers that mature organizations face: **lack of time** (the #1 barrier at the Scaling stage, cited by 42%), tool access friction, and uneven adoption across functions. Some teams are in Transformation while others are still in Experimentation. The 25% who describe momentum as "inconsistent" need targeted support - the AI Labs office hours are designed for exactly this.

THE OPPORTUNITY

BH MarCom is doing what **58% of the industry WANTS to learn how to do**. The department has a credible case to lead AI adoption not just within Marketing, but as a model for the broader organization. The governance is built, the adoption is real, and the AI Labs provide the ongoing support structure. The next step is scaling what works here across the system.

Sources: SmarterX 2026 State of AI for Business Report (n=2,109, Feb-Apr 2026) | BH MarCom AI Pulse Survey Wave 3 (n=100, Mar 2026; 303 total responses across 3 waves, Jan 2025-Mar 2026) | Baptist Health Marketing Technology | May 2026